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21 Oct 2026, 15:51

AEM Multi Site Manager (MSM) — Comprehensive Feature Guide

What MSM is for

Multi Site Manager (MSM) lets teams reuse a source site or content structure across multiple sites and control how changes flow to copies. A **Live Copy** stays related to its source through inheritance and synchronization rules; it is not just a one-time duplicate. Reusing Content - Multi Site Manager and Live Copy

Feature catalog

1. Create and manage copies of sites and content

- **Create Site from a Blueprint Configuration:** Create a site from a predefined source, using the blueprint's structure and default rollout configuration. The blueprint can help select languages or site sections to include.
- **Create a Live Copy from a page or branch:** Make a copy from a source page whether or not it is associated with a blueprint configuration.
- **Choose copy depth:** Create a *shallow* Live Copy of one page or a *deep* Live Copy including its descendants; exclude subpages when creating a copy if only the selected page is needed.
- **Create nested Live Copies:** A Live Copy can be created under another Live Copy.
- **Choose rollout configurations at creation:** Apply synchronization rules to the new Live Copy and, where configured, its descendants.
- **Use a blueprint or an ad-hoc source:** A blueprint configuration is optional for creating a Live Copy. With a configured blueprint, authors also get source-side **Rollout** functionality and **Create Site** support. Creating and Synchronizing Live Copies · Extending the Multi Site Manager

2. Propagate source changes

- **Rollout:** Push source changes to its related Live Copies. Authors can initiate rollouts from blueprint pages; rollout configurations can also define event-based triggers.
- **Synchronize:** Request synchronization from a Live Copy to pull applicable source changes into that copy.
- **Configure when synchronization runs:** Supported rollout triggers include **On Rollout**, **On Modification**, **On Activation**, and **On Deactivation**.

- **Configure what synchronization does:** Rollout configurations combine a trigger with one or more synchronization actions. They can be reused across Live Copies.
- **Customize the scope of synchronization:** Configure exclusions for certain properties, paragraph items, or node types so that selected content is not copied or updated.
- **Define custom rollout configurations:** Add a configuration when the installed options do not meet the implementation's requirements. Configuring Live Copy Synchronization · MSM Best Practices

3. Manage inheritance and local differences

MSM provides controls at both the Live Copy relationship level and, for supported content, more granular levels:

- **Cancel inheritance for a component:** Stop a component from being synchronized so an author can edit or remove it locally.
- **Re-enable component inheritance:** Restore the inheritance relationship. Re-enabling it does **not** automatically synchronize the component; request synchronization if needed.
- **Suspend a Live Copy:** Temporarily stop synchronization for a page, optionally including its children.
- **Resume a suspended Live Copy:** Restore the relationship so the copy can receive future applicable updates.
- **Detach a Live Copy:** Permanently remove its source relationship. Treat this as a one-way operation.
- **Reset a Live Copy:** Remove inheritance cancellations and return content to the source's state; local changes can be lost.
- **Control inheritance of configuration:** Choose whether child pages inherit the Live Copy configuration and whether rollout configurations are inherited from the parent. Creating and Synchronizing Live Copies · Page Properties

4. Monitor Live Copies and their relationships

- **Live Copy Overview console:** View the source/blueprint structure alongside corresponding Live Copies and their statuses.
- **Check relationship and synchronization details:** View source paths, whether a copy is suspended or in sync, its rollout configuration, and last rollout information.
- **Manage copies from the console:** Use the overview and related page properties to inspect relationships and perform available synchronization or inheritance actions.
- **Inspect blueprint references:** View the Live Copies based on a blueprint and open their overview. Live Copy Overview Console · Page Properties

5. Reuse content for multilingual and multinational sites

- Use a language master as a source and roll its content out to country or regional sites.

- Create **Language Copies** and connect them to AEM's translation integration and translation-project workflows.
- Cancel inheritance at page or component level to help protect locally translated content from being overwritten by later source updates.

Important distinction: MSM manages copying, inheritance, and synchronization; **MSM itself does not translate content**. Translation is handled through AEM's translation framework or an integrated translation connector/service. MSM Best Practices · Create a multilingual Translation Project

6. Apply synchronization actions

AEM's documented synchronization-action catalog includes actions for:

- **Content structure and values:** copy missing content, update content, delete target nodes absent from the source, edit mapped properties, and order children to match the source.
- **References:** update links or paths that point to content inside the blueprint so they point to the corresponding Live Copy resource.
- **Publication and versioning:** create a version, activate, or deactivate a Live Copy.
- **Workflow and notification:** start a configured workflow or send a rollout event.
- **Authoring permissions:** make selected actions or content/structure operations read-only for a specified group.
- **Page moves and specialized integrations:** handle source page moves and, in catalog/commerce-specific cases, product or catalog rollout behavior.

The exact action set and availability can depend on the AEM version and content type. Use the target environment's documentation when designing a rollout configuration. Configuring Live Copy Synchronization · Extending the Multi Site Manager

7. Extend MSM for implementation-specific needs

- Define custom rollout configurations using supported triggers and synchronization actions.
- Extend synchronization behavior using MSM's Java APIs and custom actions, where supported by the target AEM deployment.
- Organize action order in a rollout configuration; action ordering affects the sequence in which those actions run. Extending the Multi Site Manager

8. Use MSM with other content types

- **Content Fragments in AEMaaCS:** Create Live Copies for reuse and bulk distribution, with inheritance available down to Content Fragment fields and variations. The documented limitation is that **On Modification** triggers are not available for Content Fragments. Reuse Content Fragments using MSM and Live Copies

- **Assets and folders:** MSM for Assets supports Live Copies, rollout/synchronization, status review, and field-level metadata inheritance controls. Asset-specific configuration rules apply; Adobe's Assets guidance says to use the Standard rollout configuration for MSM for Assets. Reuse assets using MSM
- **Experience Fragments:** Adobe's AEM 6.5 MSM UI documentation also describes using MSM with Experience Fragments. Check the documentation for your exact AEM version and content model before including them in a Cloud Service design. Reusing Content: Multi Site Manager and Live Copy

Planning constraints and cautions

- **On Modification rollouts** can run after each page change, affecting authoring performance; event ordering and concurrent updates can also cause unexpected results or conflicts. Use them only when the automation benefit justifies the tradeoff. MSM Best Practices
- **Rollout behavior is configuration-dependent:** not every property or component necessarily synchronizes; exclusions and action choices determine the result.
- **Reset is destructive to local differences; detach is permanent.** Plan these operations carefully.
- **MSM is not a translation engine.** Pair it with translation projects/connectors when you need translated content.
- **Version/content-type differences matter:** MSM for Sites pages, Assets, and Content Fragments have different supported actions and constraints.

In one sentence

Use MSM when you need **related copies of a source site or content, with governed inheritance and controlled propagation of updates**; use translation integrations and content-specific workflows for capabilities MSM does not provide itself.

Coverage checklist: Done — core features, synchronization and inheritance controls, language workflows, supported content types, extensibility, and key caveats.